



Quantum Bit in Silicon

Researchers have built quantum computer on a single atom of silicon which would leave even supercomputers behind

India's 100th Space Mission

ISRO achieved a major milestone with the launch of PSLV-C21/SPOT-6/PROITERES mission. PSLV is the first operational launch vehicle of ISRO

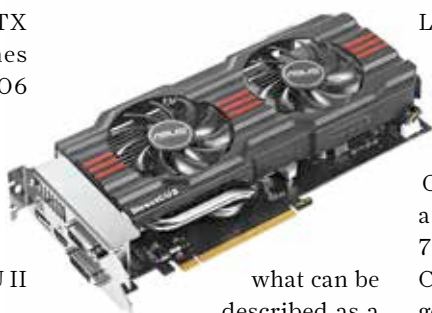
ASUS GTX 660-DC2T-2GD5

Mid-range segment ahoy!

With the GTX 660 comes the GK106 chipset which will also be soon featured in the GTX 650 Ti. This ASUS card like the name says is a Top Edition card featuring the Direct CU II heat sink.

The GTX 660 opens up NVIDIA's mid-range segment in the 600 series, along with it launched GTX 650 and all that is left is the GTX 650 Ti.

As with all other DirectCU II cards, this too has a matte black PCB. The heatsink consists of 3 heat pipes which are embedded in an aluminium die. It sits firmly atop the GPU core and spans out across



what can be described as a humungous array of fins. Only the portion that is in touch with the core is copper while the rest of the heat pipe is metal plated to avoid corrosion. There are two evenly spaced 70mm (FirstD FD7010H) brushless motor fans which handle all the airflow. The card is powered by a 6-pin connector and like most of the ASUS cards we've seen has 2

LEDs to indicate if proper contact has been achieved once the connectors are inserted.

Performance wise, the card is slightly behind the GTX 660 Ti and proves to be a worthy competitor to the HD 7950 from the AMD camp. Compared to the previous generation, the GTX 560 to be precise, the GTX 660 DC2T manages to give a performance increment of approximately 47 per cent in synthetic and about 44 per cent in gaming benchmarks. Similarly the GTX 660 is ahead by a whopping 62 per cent compared to the GTX 460. Priced at ₹18,850, the ASUS GTX 660-DC2T-2GD5 is what gamers have been waiting for.

Mithun Mohandas

Specifications

Chipset: GK106; **Bus standard:** PCI Express 3.0; **Base clock:** 1072 MHz; **Boost clock:** 1137 MHz; **Memory clock:** 6008 MHz; **Memory:** 2 GB MB GDDR5; **SLI:** 2 way SLI support; **CUDA cores:** 960; **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 270x128x38mm; **Warranty:** 3 years.

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 18002090365
Email: reachus@asus.com
Website: www.asus.in
Price: ₹18,850

7.0
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Features6.0
 Performance.....8.0
 Build Quality5.0
 Value for Money8.0

Specifications

Type: Mid-Tower; **(W / H / D):** 252 x 530.5 x 579 mm;
M/B : m-ATX, ATX, E-ATX
Front I/O Panel: USB 3.0, USB 2.0, Audio I/O, LED switch; **VGA max length (With/ W/O HDD cage):** 354.0/463.0 mm; **Warranty:** 1 year.

Contact

Cooler Master Co. Ltd.
Phone: 982020 7871
Email: sanket_naik@cooler-master.com.tw
Website: www.cooler-master.in
Price: ₹10,900/-

6.5
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Features7.0
 Performance.....7.0
 Build Quality6.0
 Value for Money6.0

CoolerMaster HAF XM

More bang for the buck!

Comes in two variants, with and without a side panel. The HAF XM is a mid-tower cabinet that supports E-ATX boards. Come to think of it, it's a mid-tower that comes with features that are normally present on high-end towers. Given the price at which this comes in at, it would be a shame if it didn't have all the bells and whistles.

As for the build quality the chassis is mostly metal, with removable plastic covers on the top and front. Has two 200mm fans on the top and front and has mounts for two more. The fan mounts also support 140 mm and 120 mm fans. The top and the front removable portions do come with wire meshes that are



fine enough to block big debris and can easily be replaced with a mesh suited for your needs. The PSU is to be mounted on the bottom and has rubber feet to cancel out any vibrations. The loudest thing we could hear was

the fan on the stock CPU cooler's radiator which we installed. The CPU cooler cutout is massive and quite frankly doesn't need to be that huge. Also, the right panel features fan mounts that can support either one 200mm fan or two 140mm fans and a handle which holds the entire thing in place akin to a car door but opens up towards the ground.

This cabinet also features the X-Dock which is basically a removable bay that supports both 3.5-inch and 2.5-inch drives and has a connector on the back so you can easily hot-swap drives.

The HAF XM is priced at a premium but given the features that it has, folks wouldn't regret fronting the moolah.

Mithun Mohandas